2) What might be the topic of this essay?

_____

3) What is the author's opinion on the topic?

_____

In Praise of the F Word

Mary Sherry

Tens of thousands of 18-year-olds will graduate this year and be handed meaningless diplomas. These diplomas won't look any different from those awarded their luckier classmates. Their validity will be questioned only when their employers discover that these graduates are **semiliterate**.

Eventually a fortunate few will find their way into educational-repair shops — adult-literacy programs, such as the one where I teach basic grammar and writing. There, high-school graduates and high-school **dropouts** pursuing graduate-equivalency certificates will learn the skills they should have learned in school. They will also discover they have been cheated by our educational system.

As I teach, I learn a lot about our schools. Early in each session I ask my students to write about an unpleasant experience they had in school. No writers' block here! "I wish someone would have had made me stop doing drugs and made me study." "I liked to party[2] and no one seemed to care." "I was a good kid and didn't cause any trouble, so they just passed me along even though I didn't read well and couldn't write." And so on.

I am your basic **do-gooder**, and prior to teaching this class I blamed the poor academic skills our kids have today on drugs, divorce and other **impediments** to

semiliterate /ˌsemɪˈlɪtərɪt/ *a.* semi-educated; having only an elementary level of reading and writing ability

semi-: half or partly

e.g. semi-skilled workers; semi-urban; semi-retirement; semi-professional; semi-conductor

dropout /ˈdrɒpaʊt/ *n.* a person who leaves school before finishing a course

e.g. Many schools in the region have appallingly high dropout rates.

Because of poor economy and feudalist mind, the dropout of girls in this area has been high.

do-gooder *n.* sb. who does things that they think will help other people, although the other people might not find their actions helpful

impediment /ɪmˈpedɪmənt/ *n.* obstacle; barrier

e.g. The new taxes were a major impediment to economic growth.

concentration necessary for doing well in school. But, as I rediscover each time I walk into the classroom, before a teacher can expect students to concentrate, he has to get their attention, no matter what distractions may be at hand. There are many ways to do this, and they have much to do with teaching style. However, if style alone won't do it, there is another way to show who holds the winning hand in the classroom. That is to reveal the *trump card* of failure.

I will never forget a teacher who played that card to get the attention of one of my children. Our youngest, a world-class **charmer**, did little to develop his intellectual talents but always *got by*. Until Mrs. Stifter.

Our son was a high-school senior when he had her for English. "He sits in the back of the room talking to his friends," she told me. "Why don't you move him to the front row?" I urged, believing the embarrassment would get him to *settle down*. Mrs. Stifter looked at me **steely**-eyed over her glasses. "I don't move seniors," she said. "I **flunk** them." I was flustered. Our son's academic life flashed before my eyes. No teacher had ever threatened him with that before. I regained my **composure** and managed to say that I thought she was right. By the time I got home I was feeling pretty good about this. It was a radical approach for these times, but, well, why not? "She's going to flunk you," I told my son. I did not discuss it any further. Suddenly English became a priority in his life. He finished out the semester with an A.

I know one example doesn't make a case, but at night school I see a **parade** of students who are angry and resentful for having been passed along until they could no longer even pretend to keep up. Of average intelligence or better, they eventually quit school, concluding they were too dumb to finish. "I should have been held back," is a comment I hear frequently. Even sadder are those students who are high school graduates who say to me after a few weeks of class, "I don't know how I ever got a high-school diploma."

Passing students who have not mastered the work cheats them and the employers who expect graduates to have basic skills. We excuse this dishon-

trump card 王牌
e.g. The unions held all the trump cards in their pay negotiation.

get by to be able to deal with a situation with difficulty, usually by having just enough of sth. you need, such as money
e.g. We can get by with four computers at the moment, but we'll need a couple more when the new staff arrive.

settle down to become quiet and calm
e.g. We're very busy this week, but things should settle down a bit after the weekend.
The teacher told the children to settle down and get on with their work.

charmer /ˈtʃɑːmə(r)/ *n.* a person who has good qualities that make you like him/her

steely /ˈstiːlɪ/ *a.* made of steel

flunk /flʌŋk/ *v.* to fail an exam or course of study
e.g. Her not following the instruction flunked her in the final exam.

composure /kəmˈpəʊʒə(r)/ *n.* calmness and control
e.g. She kept her remarkable composure throughout the funeral.

parade /pəˈreɪd/ *n.* a series of people or things that appear one after the other
e.g. a parade of players before the football match

est behavior by saying kids can't learn if they come from terrible environments. No one seems to stop to think that — no matter what environments they come from — most kids don't put school first on their list unless they perceive something is *at stake*. They'd rather be **sailing**.

Many students I see at night could give expert **testimony** on unemployment, chemical dependency[3], abusive relationships[4]. In spite of these difficulties, they have decided to make education a priority. They are motivated by the desire for a better job or the need to hang on to the one they've got. They have a healthy fear of failure.

People of all ages can rise above their problems, but they need to have a reason to do so. Young people generally don't have the maturity to value education in the same[5] way my adult students value it. But fear of failure, whether economic or academic, can motivate both.

Flunking as a regular policy has just as much merit today as it did two generations ago. We must review the threat of flunking and see it as it really is — a positive teaching tool. It is an expression of confidence by both teachers and parents that the students have the ability to learn the material presented to them. However, making it work again would take a dedicated, caring **conspiracy** between teachers and parents. It would mean facing the tough reality that passing kids who haven't learned the material — while it might save them grief for the short term — **dooms** them to long-term illiteracy. It would mean that teachers would have to *follow through* on their threats, and parents would have to stand behind them, knowing their children's best interests are indeed at stake. This means no more doing Scott's assignments for him because he might fail. No more passing Jodi because she's such a nice kid.

This is a policy that worked in the past and can work today. A wise teacher, with the support of his parents, gave our son the opportunity to succeed — or fail. It's time we return this choice to all students[6].

at stake to be won or lost; risked
e.g. This race was her last chance to win a place on the national team so everything was at stake.

follow through to continue a stroke, motion, plan, or reasoning through to the end
e.g. The essay started interestingly, but failed to follow through its argument.

sail /seɪl/ *v.* to move quickly and effortlessly
e.g. Manchester United sailed on to victory in the final. Rachel sailed through the exam with no mistakes.

testimony /'testɪmənɪ/ *n.* spoken or written statement that sth. is true
e.g. Your success is a testimony of all your hard work. The reports are testimony to the many hours of research completed by this committee.

conspiracy /kən'spɪrəsɪ/ *n.* act of joint planning of a crime
e.g. She has been charged with conspiracy to murder. Fifteen years working for the same firm and she still hadn't been promoted — there was a conspiracy against her.

doom /du:m/ *v.* to make sb. or sth. certain to do or experience sth. unpleasant
e.g. Mounting debts doomed the factory to closure.

2) What does the word "disingenuousness" (Line 1) probably mean?

Tracing the Cigarette's Path from Sexy to Deadly

Howard Markel, M.D.[1]

For many Americans, the tobacco industry's **disingenuousness** became a matter of public record during a Congressional hearing on April 14, 1994. There, under the **withering** glare of Representative Henry A. Waxman, Democrat of California, appeared the chief executives of the seven largest American tobacco companies.

In the 1930s and 1940s, cigarettes were either healthy because they were implicitly **endorsed** by a kindly doctor, or sexy.

Each executive raised his right hand and solemnly swore to tell the whole truth about his business. In **sequential testimony**, each one stated that he did not believe tobacco was a health risk and that his company had taken no steps to manipulate the levels of **nicotine** in its cigarettes.

disingenuousness /ˌdɪsɪnˈdʒenjʊəsnɪs/ *n.* slight dishonesty and lack of sincerity
e.g. *Curiously, the disingenuousness of that report has never been challenged.*

withering /ˈwɪðərɪŋ/ *a.* (of a look or remark, etc.) scornful or contemptuous
e.g. *Be prepared to question this if you want to, and do not retreat from any withering looks.*
The professor gave a withering look to the boy student who made catcalls in class.

endorse /ɪnˈdɔːs/ *v.* to express formal support or approval
e.g. *After heated discussion, many senators endorsed the new bill on tax reduction.*
Huntley refused to endorse any candidate who did not share his views on gun control.

sequential /sɪˈkwenʃəl/ *a.* following in order of time or place
e.g. *Normally, logical thought develops in a series of sequential steps.*
Many students drifted in and out schools without making any sequential progress at all.

testimony /ˈtestɪmənɪ/ *n.* written or spoken statement declaring that sth. is true, esp. one made under oath
e.g. *As one of the most important witnesses in this case, Barker will present a crucial testimony in the court.*
In his testimony, he denied that the company had ignored safety procedures.

nicotine /ˈnɪkətiːn/ *n.* poisonous oily substance found in tobacco

Thirty years after the famous surgeon general's report declaring cigarette smoking a health hazard, the tobacco executives, it seemed, were among the few who believed otherwise.

But it was not always that way. Allan M. Brandt, a medical historian at Harvard, insists that recognizing the dangers of cigarettes resulted from an intellectual process that took *the better part of* the 20th century. He describes this fascinating story in his new book, *The Cigarette Century: The Rise, Fall and Deadly Persistence of the Product that Defined America* (Basic Books).

In contrast to the symbol of death and disease it is today, from the early 1900s to the 1960s the cigarette was a cultural icon of **sophistication**, glamour and sexual **allure** — a highly prized commodity for one out of two Americans.

Many advertising campaigns from the 1930s through the 1950s **extolled** the healthy virtues of cigarettes. Full-color magazine ads depicted kindly doctors **clad** in white coats proudly lighting up or puffing away, with slogans like "More doctors smoke Camels[2] than any other cigarettes."

Early in the 20th century, opposition to cigarettes took a moral rather than a health-conscious[3] tone, especially for women who wanted to smoke, although even then many doctors were concerned that smoking was a health risk.

The 1930s were a period when many Americans began smoking and the most significant health effects had not yet developed. As a result, the scientific studies of the era often failed to find clear evidence of serious **pathology**

the better part of the majority of; the biggest part of
e.g. Another child makes the family wretched with his crying for the better part of an hour.
It is not widely taught or particularly popular because it takes the better part of a lifetime to master.

sophistication /səˌfɪstɪˈkeɪʃən/ *n.* quality of being sophisticated
e.g. James Bond is known for his sophistication, his style and his sense of class.

allure /əˈl(j)ʊə(r)/ *n.* a mysterious, exciting, or desirable quality
e.g. Fatty snacks can soon lose their allure if you have nothing else to eat.
"Super Mario" is an old game that has lost much of its allure during the past decade.

extol /ɪksˈtəʊl/ *v.* (*fml.*) to praise highly
e.g. All the writings that extolled the role of Mary were ultimately excluded from the canon.
Everywhere, the glory of the ancient era is extolled in stone.

clad /klæd/ *a.* dressed; clothed
e.g. She felt hot, despite being clad only in a thin cotton dress.

pathology /pəˈθɒlədʒɪ/ *n.* scientific study of diseases of the body

and had the **perverse** effect of **exonerating** the cigarette.

The years after World War II, however, were a time of major breakthroughs in **epidemiological** thought. In 1947, Richard Doll and A. Bradford Hill of the British Medical Research Council created a sophisticated statistical technique to document the association between rising rates of lung cancer and increasing numbers of smokers.

The prominent surgeon Evarts A. Graham and a medical student, Ernst L. Wynder, published a **landmark** article in 1950 comparing the incidence of lung cancer in their nonsmoking and smoking patients at Barnes Hospital in St. Louis. They concluded that "cigarette smoking, over a long period, is at least one important factor in the striking increase in **bronchogenic** cancer."

Predictably, the tobacco companies — and their expert **surrogates** — **derided** these and other studies as mere statistical arguments or anecdotes rather than definitions of causality.

Dr. Brandt, who has **exhaustively** combed through the tobacco companies' internal **memorandums** and research documents, amply demonstrates that Big Tobacco[4] understood many of the health risks of their products long before the 1964 surgeon general's report.

perverse /pə'vɜːs/ *a.* deliberately or stubbornly turning away from what is reasonable or required
e.g. People in Minneapolis take a perverse pride in how cold their winters are.

exonerate /ɪg'zɒnəreɪt/ *v.* to declare sb. free from blame
e.g. Strangely enough, the mischievous boy was totally exonerated from any blame.
Sometimes he punished himself when others were inclined to exonerate him.

epidemiological /ˌepɪˌdiːmɪə'lɒdʒɪkəl/ *a.* connected with the study of the way diseases spread, and how to control them

landmark /'lændmɑːk/ *n.* an event or development that marks a turning point or a stage
e.g. The discovery of penicillin was a landmark in the history of medicine in the 20th century.
The Supreme Court issued a landmark decision on the health risks of tobacco in January 2001.

bronchogenic /ˌbrɒŋkəʊ'dʒenɪk/ *a.* deriving from the bronchial tubes

surrogate /'sʌrəgɪt/ *n.* (*fml.*) person or thing that acts or is used instead of another; substitute
e.g. The President's surrogates have been campaigning for him nonstop.
Scientists have been experimenting the use of bright-light therapy as a surrogate for sunshine.

deride /dɪ'raɪd/ *v.* to treat sb./sth. as funny and not worthy of serious attention
e.g. The party was doomed to fail the election because it has been derided as totally lacking in ideas.
You shouldn't deride their efforts because they've already tried hard.

exhaustively /ɪg'zɔːstɪvlɪ/ *adv.* very thoroughly; completely
e.g. The officer had to explain all the points of the military plan exhaustively to the commander.

memorandum /ˌmemə'rændəm/ *n.* informal written business communication

He also describes the concerted **disinformation** campaigns these companies waged for more than half a century — simultaneously **obfuscating** scientific evidence and spreading the belief that since everyone knew cigarettes were dangerous at some level, smoking was essentially an issue of personal choice and responsibility rather than a corporate one.

In the 1980s, scientists established the revolutionary concept that nicotine is extremely addictive. The tobacco companies publicly rejected such claims, even as they took advantage of cigarettes' addictive potential by routinely **spiking** them with extra nicotine to make it harder to quit smoking. And their marketing memorandums document advertising campaigns aimed at youngsters to hook whole new generations of smokers.

In 2004, Dr. Brandt was recruited by the Department of Justice to serve as its star expert witness in the federal **racketeering** case against Big Tobacco and to counter the **gaggle** of witnesses recruited by the industry. According to their own testimony, most of the 29 historians testifying on behalf of Big Tobacco did not even consult the industry's internal research or communications. Instead, these experts focused primarily on a small group of **skeptics** of the dangers of cigarettes during the 1950s, many of whom had or would eventually have ties to the tobacco industry.

"I was appalled by what the tobacco expert witnesses had written," Dr. Brandt

---

disinformation /ˌdɪsɪnfəˈmeɪʃən/ *n.* false information intended to mislead

e.g. *Wallace says his job was to spread government disinformation to extremist groups.*
In a meeting, Mrs. Aquino said the rebels had started a disinformation campaign to weaken her government.

obfuscate /ˈɒbfʌskeɪt/ *v.* to make (sth.) confused or difficult to understand

e.g. *Politicians have once again obfuscated the issue, but they will never fool the public this time.*
Macdonald accepted that such information could be used to manipulate, to obfuscate, and to mislead.

spike /ˈspaɪk/ *v.* to fasten or furnish with spikes

e.g. *Anti-logging activists often spike trees to prevent them from being cut down by local farmers.*

racketeering /ˌrækɪˈtɪərɪŋ/ *n.* making money from illegal activities such as threatening people or selling worthless, immoral, or illegal goods or services

e.g. *Edwards was arrested and indicted on racketeering charges but never convicted.*
The former CEO of a multinational company has been arrested on racketeering charges.

gaggle /ˈgægl/ *n.* a group of people, especially those that are noisy or disorganized

e.g. *Somehow he did his duty, and Gladys joined the growing gaggle of young women.*

skeptic /ˈskeptɪk/ *n.* a person who has doubts about things that other people believe.

e.g. *Skeptics argued that the rise in prices was temporary and would not necessarily lead to inflation.*
A lot of my friends believe in astrology, but I'm a skeptic myself.

said in a recent interview. "By asking narrow questions and responding to them with narrow research, they provided precisely the cover the industry sought."

Apparently, the judge, Gladys Kessler of Federal District Court for the District of Columbia[5], agreed. Last August, she concluded that the tobacco industry had engaged in a 40-year conspiracy to **defraud** smokers about tobacco's health dangers. Her opinion cited Dr. Brandt's testimony more than 100 times.

Dr. Brandt acknowledges that there are pitfalls in combining scholarship with battle against the deadly **pandemic** of cigarette smoking, but he says he sees little alternative.

"If one of us occasionally crosses the boundary between analysis and **advocacy**, so be it," he said. "The stakes are high[6], and there is much work to be done."

Notes

1. Howard Markel: The author is a professor of pediatrics, psychiatry and the history of medicine at the University of Michigan.
2. Camel: A brand of cigarettes that was introduced by American company R.J. Reynolds Tobacco in the summer of 1913. It is currently one of the most popular brands of cigarettes in the US. Most Camels contain a blend of Turkish and Virginia tobacco. The brand's catch-phrase slogan, used for decades, was "I'd walk a mile for a Camel!" Winston-Salem, North Carolina, the city where RJR was founded, was nicknamed "Camel City" at one time because of the brand's popularity.
3. health-conscious: conscious of health; health-aware
4. Big Tobacco: A pejorative term often applied to the tobacco industry in general, or more particularly to the "big three" tobacco corporations in the United States. The term usually refers to tobacco companies Philip Morris (Altria), R. J. Reynolds (RJR) and British American Tobacco, but can also include other companies with a major stake in tobacco consumption, such as

---

defraud /dɪˈfrɔːd/ *v.* to get sth. from sb. by deception; cheat sb.
e.g. *Rumors held it that she defrauded her employers of thousands of pounds.*
John is charged with attempting to defraud his business partner.

pandemic /pænˈdemɪk/ *n.* a disease that affects many people over a very wide area

advocacy /ˈædvəkəsɪ/ *n.* public support for a course of action
e.g. *The senator Ehrlich is known for his consistent advocacy of capital punishment.*
Meanwhile, Hong Kong advocacy groups Tuesday announced plans to fight the proposed changes.

2) Is it right that a government can play a part in contributing to the happiness of people? If yes, then in what way?

Aristotle[1] Got It Right

David Cameron[2]

Well-being, not just wealth, should mark the progress of our societies.It is hard to escape the fact that in developed societies, despite progress, **innovation** and prosperity, there is something not quite right. In some cases, it is hard for people to *put a finger on* it: a feeling of emptiness and not belonging, a lack of **defined** relationships[3] and solid social structures. In other respects, it is really **quantifiable**: rates of drug abuse, violent crime and depression and suicide are **rocketing**. Why are we so unhappy? It seems that the Enlightenment[4] brought forth unparalleled liberty in economic, social and political life, but we are now undergoing a midlife crisis.

The politics of happiness[5] is nothing new. In his *Nicomachean Ethics*[6], Aristotle said that *eudaimonia*[7], or happiness, is the goal of life. But for me, the person who brings the great **conundrum** of personal happiness alive is Robert Kennedy. In a beautifully **crafted** speech, he said what "makes life worthwhile" is "the health of our children, the quality of

put a finger on sth. to know the reason for something, esp. something that is a problem; identify precisely or point out (an error, the cause of a problem, etc.)
e.g. I can't quite put my finger on the flaw in her argument.
I know there's something wrong, but I can't put my finger on exactly what it is.

innovation /ˌɪnə(ʊ)ˈveɪʃən/ *n.* the process of making improvements by introducing something new; the act of introducing something new; something newly introduced
e.g. Too many rules tend to stifle innovation.
Other innovations included a plan for maternity leave.

define /dɪˈfaɪn/ *v.* to show clearly the edge of sth.
e.g. The outline of the castle on the hill was clearly defined against the evening sky.

quantifiable /ˈkwɒntɪˌfaɪəbl/ *a.* can be quantified, measured; capable of being quantified
e.g. The benefits of the new policy are not easily quantifiable.

rocket /ˈrɒkɪt/ *v.* to move extremely quickly
e.g. He rocketed to stardom (ie. became famous) overnight.

conundrum /kəˈnʌndrəm/ *n.* a problem that is difficult to deal with
e.g. A remote county in Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region has solved the insoluble rural credit conundrum, entirely on its own.
If a person is a conundrum, they are difficult to understand or deal with.

craft /krɑːft/ *v.* to make (sth.) skillfully, esp. by hand
e.g. a beautifully crafted silver brooch
a cleverly crafted poem

their education, the joy of their play," "the strength of our marriages … our devotion to our country" and our "wit … wisdom and courage." And he pointed out that none of these could be measured by gross national product[8].

Nor could we be surprised by the politics of happiness. Ask people how they are, and they will answer in terms of their family life, community life and work life, rather than just what they are paid.

Despite this, it is a notoriously difficult subject[9] for politicians to grasp. One reason is that happiness and well-being are generally not well served by statistical analysis. Politicians, obsessed with inputs and outputs, targets and controls, are **flummoxed** by immeasurable concepts such as the value people place on spending time with their families. Another reason, which is related, is that electoral cycles *lend themselves to* a culture of short-termism, with a need for immediate, quantifiable measurements and results.

One such measurement is GDP[10]. In many ways, increasing this has been the *raison d'etre* for many center-right[11] political parties since the 1980s. Back then, many developed economics were in a state of economic **malaise**, with persistently high inflation and unemployment. We needed something to reverse this **stagnation** and put us back onto the path of prosperity. Thankfully, we got that.

Today we need to be just as revolutionary to put us back on track to

lend oneself to to allow oneself to be associated with sth.; adapt oneself or set oneself up to be treated in a special way

e.g. Alice wouldn't lend herself to the plot to hide the teacher's chalk.

raison d'être (French) a basic, essential purpose; a reason to exist, reason for or justification of sb.'s/sth.'s existence

e.g. Work seems to be her raison d'être.

After his wife died, his children became his raison d'être.

Professor Naylor argues that in the nuclear age, infantry forces have lost their raison d'être.

flummox /ˈflʌməks/ *v.* to bewilder, confuse or disconcert (sb.)

e.g. And when a poll's results happen to upset the conventional wisdom, or confound the experts, or flummox the pundits, then that's a poll to remember.

The chronological order of the Stuart, Hanover, Lancaster and Tudor British royal houses had me flummoxed.

malaise /mæˈleɪz/ *n.* a general feeling of bad health or lack of energy, or an uncomfortable feeling that something is wrong (esp. with society) and a lack of ability to change the situation

e.g. She wrote about the depression and malaise felt by women trapped in their suburban homes.

They claim it is a symptom of a deeper and more general malaise in society.

They spoke of the feeling of moral and spiritual malaise, the lack of will to do anything.

stagnation /stægˈneɪʃən/ *n.* (*fig.*) state of showing no activity (and therefore not developing or progressing)

e.g. A fear of unemployment is one of the main factors behind the current stagnation in the property market.

If the economic stagnation in many countries is to be overcome, trade needs to be increased between industrial and developing nations.

social prosperity: to respond to that **yearning** for happiness. That is why I have been arguing in Britain that we need to refocus our energies on GWB — general well-being. It means recognizing the social, cultural and moral factors that give true meaning to our lives. In particular, it means focusing on a sustainable environment and building stronger societies. And yes, it also means recognizing that there is more to life than money: indeed, that quality of life means more than the quantity of money.

I think the center-right can be the champions of this cause. The center-left[12] never really get the well-being agenda because they treat individuals as units of account. And they find it difficult to understand how it cannot be delivered simply by the push of a legislator's pen[13].

Instead, the politics of well-being is a politics that needs to be founded on sharing responsibility. Of course, government must take its own responsibilities. But that needs to be part of a wider cultural change: a cultural change that will occur as a consequence of legislation, leadership and social change.

What's the government's role? It is to show leadership and set the framework. Showing leadership means leading the change in the many areas that impact on well-being. For example, everyone would agree that spending more time with family is crucial to happiness. Here governments should be pioneers of flexible working with public-sector employees.

Setting the right framework means creating **incentives** and removing barriers to remodel the context within which the whole of society makes choices. Take the environment for example. Everyone would agree that a cleaner local environment would enhance our well-being. By setting a framework that creates a price for carbon in our economy and encourages *green innovation*, the government can help people make the better choice.

green innovation innovation which helps to protect the environment

---

yearning /ˈjɜːnɪŋ/ *n.* strong desire, tender longing

e.g. *All the great love stories are about frustrated yearning rather than contented fulfillment.*
I suppose it's because I live in a crowded city that I have this yearning for open spaces.
His poems are full of unfulfilled yearnings and desires.

incentive /ɪnˈsentɪv/ *n.* thing that encourages sb. to do sth.; stimulus

e.g. *the offer of cash incentives*
In economics, an incentive is any factor (financial or non-financial) that provides a motive for a particular course of action, or counts as a reason for preferring one choice to the alternatives.

Ultimately, society's happiness requires us all to play our part. Indeed, playing our part is part of being happy. That is why we need a revolution in responsibility. Corporate responsibility means businesses taking a **provocative** role, and taking account of their employees' lives. Civic responsibility means giving power back to local government, community organizations and social enterprises so they can formulate local solutions to local problems. And personal responsibility means we all do our bit in cleaning up our local environment or participating in local politics.

Neil Browne, professor of economics at Bowling Green State University, recently wrote an article: "If Markets Are So Wonderful, Why Can't I Find Friends at the Store?" It is not that markets are bad or that we are all doomed to a life of **perpetual** unhappiness. Rather, given our advances in terms of political freedom, economic enterprise and cultural **ingenuity**, life could, and should, be more satisfying. That is why focusing on general well-being could be the big, defining political concept of the 21st century. And by recognizing the responsibility every section of society has, we also have the means to enhance it.

Notes

1. Aristotle (384 BC–322 BC): a Greek philosopher, a student of Plato and teacher of Alexander the Great. He wrote on diverse subjects, including physics, metaphysics, poetry (including theater), biology and zoology, logic, rhetoric, politics, government, and ethics. Along with Socrates and Plato, Aristotle was one of the most influential of the ancient Greek philosophers. They transformed Presocratic Greek philosophy into the foundations of Western philosophy as we know it. Some consider Plato and Aristotle to have founded two of the most important schools of Ancient philosophy; others consider Aristotelianism as a development and concretization of Plato's insights.

---

provocative /prəˈvɒkətɪv/ *a.* tending or intended to arouse anger, annoyance, controversy, etc.

e.g. *The next day Danglars was again hungry; certainly the air of that dungeon was very provocative of appetite.*

perpetual /pəˈpetʃʊəl/ *a.* continuing indefinitely; permanent

e.g. *The unforgettable past continues to stir their hearts, causing a perpetual motion of passions and repressed desires.*

ingenuity /ˌɪndʒɪˈnjuːɪtɪ/ *n.* cleverness and originality in solving problems

e.g. *Imaginative works represent ingenuity and imagination created from human experience, and as is all known to everyone, novels, plays, films, fairy tales, and legends stand for one kind of human experiences.*

Drug smugglers constantly use their ingenuity to find new ways of getting drugs into a country.

3) What is the purpose of the writer in writing the essay?

Give Globalization a Hand

Ernesto Zedillo[1]

Here's a fact worth **reiterating**: despite the severe shocks and imbalances that have hit it off and on during the early years of this century, the world economy continues to grow, with low inflation. Of course, performance varies across countries and continents, but there are two generalizations you can make: The already rich countries keep enjoying expanding economies, and in the rest of the world millions of people overcome poverty every year, thanks to economic growth. Is there a force underlying this **benign** evolution that **transcends** national borders? Yes. That force is international economic integration — or globalization, if you wish. The market economy's capacity to fulfill human needs is being enhanced to an **unprecedented** extent by international trade and investment.

National economies have become increasingly interdependent, and on the whole this process has added scale, flexibility and productivity to the global economy. Facilitated by modern transportation and communications and the elimination of trade barriers, specialization — that crucial vehicle of the market economy — has become more and more sophisticated, as shown by the complexity and efficiency of contemporary supply chains. In today's global economy, firms and countries no longer specialize in the production of goods alone but increasingly in the finer tasks

reiterate /rɪˈɪtəreɪt/ *v.* to say or do again or repeatedly

e.g. *He reiterated his opposition to the creation of a central bank when all the other members were ready to vote for it.*

I want to reiterate that our conventional weapons are superior.

benign /bɪˈnaɪn/ *a.* tending to exert a beneficial influence; favorable

e.g. *This plunge of the stock market came in a time of relatively benign economic conditions.*

Her condition turned for the better due to the benign influence of pure air in the mountain village.

transcend /trænˈsend/ *v.* to pass beyond the limits of

e.g. *The best films are those which transcend national or cultural barriers.*

The underlying message of the film is that love transcends everything else.

unprecedented /ʌnˈpresɪdentɪd/ *a.* never having happened or existed in the past

e.g. *This century has witnessed environmental destruction on an unprecedented scale.*

Only support for a comprehensive and sustained response to the epidemic can begin to reverse the unprecedented global impact of HIV and AIDS.

that make up the manufacturing, commercial and financial processes, bringing about lower costs, better quality and more choices for consumers.

Great Source of Strength

Globalization is providing the world with not only greater economic opportunities but also a remarkable **resilience** to events that in the past would have proven highly **disruptive**. If you consider recent regional wars, terrorism, the **skyrocketing** prices of oil and other commodities, and the **laxity** in the **fiscal** and monetary policies of some of the major economies, you may conclude that it's only through the globalization of the market economy that we've been able to sail through such stormy waters.

For example, the slack in global demand created by the **sluggishness** in the European and Japanese economies during past years was more than compensated for by the rapid and vigorous globalization of China and other emerging economies. The new players have made world trade more dynamic and enlarged the pool of world savings available to finance the substantial current account deficits[2] **incurred** by the U.S. in recent years. Although of questionable sustainability and convenience in the medium and long term, these deficits have nevertheless helped to

resilience /rɪˈzɪlɪəns/ *n.* the ability to recover quickly from illness, change, or misfortune

e.g. *The information within this brochure describes resilience and some factors that affect how people deal with hardship.*

Building resilience — the ability to adapt well to unexpected changes and events — can help us manage stress and feelings of anxiety and uncertainty related to war.

disruptive /dɪsˈrʌptɪv/ *a.* causing trouble and therefore stopping something from continuing as usual

e.g. *His teacher described him as a noisy, disruptive influence in class.*

In times of disruptive change your expected future is no longer valid. Leaders need to think and act differently in order to chart a new course for the enterprise.

skyrocket /ˈskaɪrɒkɪt/ *v.* to rise or cause to rise rapidly and suddenly

e.g. *Housing prices have skyrocketed in recent months.*

Did you read the news in the paper saying that Japan's Fujifilm sees profits skyrocket eightfold?

laxity /ˈlæksɪtɪ/ *n.* the state or quality of being lax

e.g. *The laxity of export control authorities has made a significant contribution to the problem.*

fiscal /ˈfɪskl/ *a.* of or relating to finance or finances

e.g. *Fiscal policy is the economic term that defines the set of principles and decisions of a government in setting the level of public expenditure and how that expenditure is funded.*

sluggishness /ˈslʌgɪʃnɪs/ *n.* inactivity; showing an unusual lack of energy

e.g. *Part of the explanation for this sluggishness reflects what's happening in construction — given the slump in housing, it should come as no surprise that investment in construction-related equipment has fallen off.*

incur /ɪnˈkɜː(r)/ *v.* to experience something, usually something unpleasant, as a result of actions you have taken

e.g. *The play has incurred the wrath/anger of both audiences and critics.*

An enterprise has to incur certain costs and expenses in order to stay in business.

support overall demand and growth in the short term — without, as yet, shaking international financial stability. The sharp increase in commodity prices over the last three years has not led to unbearable inflationary pressure because of the increasing presence of labor-abundant countries in world markets and the rise in productivity brought about by the **intensification** of global competition.

Don't Forget History

Globalization has, in short, been an incredible force for good in the world. But is this force inexhaustible? Unfortunately, no. Modern globalization has so far proved stronger than the forces and events **arrayed** against it, but there's no guarantee this will always be the case. Just as with any other economic or social phenomenon, globalization faces risks that could challenge its growth or, worse, cause its reversal. This has happened before, most dramatically in 1914, with the outbreak of World War I, the beginning of the end of an extraordinary expansion in international trade, investment and migration that had taken place during most of the 19th and early 20th centuries.

Historians and economists increasingly remind us that human **folly** could once again cause the unthinkable. The inability to prevent violent conflict, as well as faulty policies in the face of economic **adversity**, were at the root of the incredible destruction of life, capital, trade and prosperity suffered by the pre-baby-boom generations of the 20th century. The strategies to tackle a new wave of globalization reversal are no mystery; they were learned through hard experience.

The pursuit of progress and security at the global level starts by every country's keeping its house in order, especially those that have a responsibility to lead by example. Part of this includes a country's supporting, in a rational way, its own people as they adapt to the **rigors** inherent in free and open markets. Another

intensification /ɪnˈtensɪfɪˈkeɪʃən/ *n.* action that makes something stronger or more extreme

e.g. *Expansion and intensification of cultivation are among the predominant global changes of this century.*

array /əˈreɪ/ *v.* to arrange a group of things in a particular way

e.g. *Arrayed (= Standing in a group) before him were 40 schoolchildren in purple and green.*
Over 10 thousand pots of flowers were arrayed on the square of the Grand Theater to greet the coming great event of the city.

folly /ˈfɒlɪ/ *n.* stupidity, or a stupid action, idea, etc.

e.g. *It would be folly for the country to become involved in the war.*
Unlike the typical history which tackles a period and/or region, this book examines, in detail, four instances of folly in human history.

adversity /ədˈvɜːsɪtɪ/ *n.* a difficult or unlucky situation or event

e.g. *Adversity reveals genius; fortune conceals it. Hence, we may be sure that days of adversity, as well as days of prosperity, are full of blessing.*

rigor /ˈrɪgə(r)/ *n.* something that is hard to endure

e.g. *The expedition suffered all the rigors of a Canadian winter.*

essential component is rules-based international cooperation, particularly when it comes to[3] containing or **dissipating geopolitical** threats to global stability.

Following World War II this concept of cooperation was **embodied** in various institutions and **covenants**, which, for the most part, worked well for many years. Lately, however, the value of international cooperation seems to have been forgotten. More frequently than not[4] international laws, agreements and institutions are **bypassed**, and various attempts to update these indispensable instruments have failed roundly. The vision and leadership that created and sustained them over time is now missing. We were harshly reminded of this vacuum this summer, first with the latest collapse of the Doha Round[5] and then with a new military **conflagration** in the Middle East. Fortunately, the latter has — at least for the time being — been **subdued**, **revealingly**, by old-fashioned diplomacy and an institution much **vilified** in recent years: the United Nations.

---

dissipate /ˈdɪsɪpeɪt/ *v.* to (cause to) gradually disappear or waste

e.g. *The heat gradually dissipates into the atmosphere.*
This peaceful river will dissipate your fatigue and relieve your nervous tension.

geopolitical /ˈdʒiːəʊpəˈlɪtɪkəl/ *a.* 地理政治学的

embody /ɪmˈbɒdɪ/ *v.* to represent a quality or an idea exactly

e.g. *This paper revisits the hypothesis that technical change is embodied in capital.*
Mr. Clinton is outspoken in his support for a multilateral trading system embodied by the GATT.

covenant /ˈkʌvənənt/ *n.* a binding agreement; a compact

e.g. *In fact, Microsoft's patent covenants have arguably made things more complicated for other corporations.*
A conservation covenant is a voluntary agreement between a landowner and an authorized body to help the landowner protect and manage the environment on their property.

bypass /ˈbaɪpɑːs/ *v.* to ignore a rule or official authority

e.g. *They bypassed the committee and went straight to senior management.*

conflagration /ˌkɒnfləˈgreɪʃən/ *n.* a large and violent event, such as a war, involving a lot of people

e.g. *Two days after the fire they decided to include this fire in the project in order to learn as much as possible from the conflagration.*

subdue /səbˈdjuː/ *v.* to reduce the force of something, or to prevent something from existing or developing

e.g. *Three Greyhound passengers, including an off-duty female bus driver, subdued a man who had thrown himself onto the driver and steering wheel, saying he wanted to die.*
He criticized the school for trying to subdue individual expression.

revealing /rɪˈviːlɪŋ/ *a.* showing or making known
revealingly *adv.*

e.g. *What is it that differentiates human beings most revealingly? Some say it is their varying degrees of compassion; others say it is amounts of prudence. But in truth nothing is so revealing as a person's sense of humor.*

vilify /ˈvɪlɪfaɪ/ *v.* to say or write unpleasant things about someone or something, in order to cause other people to have a bad opinion of them

e.g. *He was vilified by the press as a monster of perversity.*
During this election season, many people are trying to vilify Schwarzenegger so that he won't be reelected.